Indie Item Shoppe TL;DR

What do I need to do?

- Opt in to the Indie Item Shoppe on your dev checklist and provide us with all requested information **by the deadlines**. (found in “Selling Merchandise”)
- Bring your merch to the Item Shoppe (or arrange to ship it in advance).
    - All t-shirts **must** be individually rolled or wrapped (and secured to stay that way) with the type and size clearly labeled. Unlabeled/unrolled shirts will not be accepted.
- Check in with us when you arrive at the event to confirm your details.
- Check out with us and pick up any unsold merch on Sunday.
- Watch your email after the event for your final sales report and payment!

What are the important dates and deadlines?

- Opt in on your Dev Checklist by **November 16, 2026**
- Fill out Item Shoppe inventory in Dev Checklist by **December 13, 2026**
- Receive payment via check or electronic transfer by **January 30, 2027**

What are the hours Indie Item Shoppe is open to the public?

Thurs: 2pm-10pm

Fri, Sat: 8am-10pm

Sun: 8am-12pm

When and how do I give you my merch?

- Devs/studios may drop off their merch between the following hours:
    - Wednesday Jan 6: 4pm - 10pm
    - Thursday Jan 7: 9am - 2pm
- All merchandise should arrive **no later than Thursday 2pm**
- If you instead want to ship to our warehouse (at your own expense), do so by **December 20, 2026** and then check in with us when you arrive on-site.

Indie Item Shoppe 2026 FAQ

What is the Indie Item Shoppe?

Indie Item Shoppe is a volunteer-staffed service offered to developers/studios by the MAGFest Indies Department to sell their merchandise in a central, high-traffic area. Not all devs are able to display or sell merch at their own booths, so the Item Shoppe provides that space and sells your merch on your behalf. This gives devs the option to enjoy the event and manage their own booths while giving attendees a centralized, easy experience to find merchandise.

How does it work?

Opt in through your Dev Checklist, and then let us know what kind of merch you'll be bringing in the inventory list! When you arrive at the Gaylord, bring us your merch - we'll count it and confirm your prices. Throughout the weekend, our staff make the sales, while you enjoy the event and exhibit your games. On Sunday, come pick up any unsold merch, and you'll get your payment a few weeks later, along with a complete accounting of what items sold.

Am I able to sell merch through the Indie Item Shoppe and also sell merch at our booth?

No! In order to minimize confusion, devs/studios are only allowed to sell merch through the Indie Item Shoppe **or** at their own booths **but not both**. However, you may also advertise or display your merch near your game!

What are the hours Indie Item Shoppe is open to the public?

Thurs: 2pm-10pm

Fri, Sat: 8am-10pm

Sun: 8am-12pm

Where is it located?

The Indie Item Shoppe is connected to the Indies Staff Ops booth, in the centre of the Indies Hall (Expo Hall C).

How safe is our stuff?

Because it is located within the ops booth, we are able to put away merch during off hours, and the inventory is under staff supervision at all times.

How are inventory and sales handled? Is there a charge for this service? How do we get our money?

MAGFest will not be taking any cut of your sales! This service is provided at no cost to you by MAGFest, as we feel it's an important service we want to offer devs/studios in order to support the indie game community. In accordance with MAGFest's Cash Handling Procedures, trusted Staff will use iPads running the Square app for all purchases and to track inventory. Please note we only accept electronic payments, no cash. . Square keeps a percentage of credit card sales (2.6% + 15¢ on all credit card transactions; see their pricing page for more information: https://squareup.com/pricing). Maryland sales tax rate of 6% will also be properly handled for you. In accordance with MAGFest's MoneyHandling Procedures, only trusted Staff will be able to handle purchases. Taxes and fees will be deducted from gross sales (ex. if an attendee purchases a shirt priced at $20, you would receive approximately $18.13) so **please price accordingly**! About a week after the event, you will receive an email with your final breakdown of sales - you need to respond to that email for your payment to be sent! **Your net proceeds will be sent to you no later than January 30, 2027, either by mailed check or by electronic transfer (PayPal payment), based on the information you provide in your form.**

How do we get our merch to the Indie Item Shoppe?

We expect most devs/studios to bring their merch with them when they arrive, which is the method we recommend. If you are bringing your merch with you, we will have volunteers available to assist, if needed (the earlier you get there, the quicker it will be!). Devs/studios may drop off their merch between the following hours:

- Wednesday Jan 6: 4pm - 10pm
- Thursday Jan 7: 9am - 2pm

All merchandise should arrive at Indie Item Shoppe no later than 2pm Thursday. This is to ensure that we have enough time to properly account for all merchandise before the event so inventory is accurate and nothing gets lost. Please note, we will gladly make exceptions for those who need it (if you don't arrive until Friday, just let us know so we can expect you!), but know that we won't have as much time to sell your wares to your adoring fans ;)

****If you don't let us know you need an exception, we will expect you by 2pm Thursday!****

How does check-in work?

Check-ins will happen at the Indie Item Shoppe table, and will be performed by a dedicated Indie Item Shoppe Staffer. All inventory will be counted and entered into Square. This will make it easy for us to tell you how sales are going if at any time during the event you want to stop by. We suggest that you plan check-in to take about 30 minutes. **All t-shirts must be individually rolled or wrapped (and secured to stay that way) with the size and style clearly labeled for easy handling.** Stickers should come in a closed container/bag as well. It's best if we know about all merch ahead of time to make the check-in process smooth and quick, as there will be many devs/studios coming in during the early times of the event. In addition, if we know what you'll be bringing, we can be better prepared to display and advertise your items.

I'm coming from far away, is there an option to ship my merch to you? Can I ship my merch directly to the convention center?

Option A: Although we recommend bringing your own merch, you may ship your merch to our warehouse in advance (at your own expense; MAGFest does not cover shipping). All items must be received by no later than December 20, 2026. Shipping can be slow around the holidays, so please account for that in your timeline! Our logistics staff will transport your merch to the Indies Item Shoppe, but you still need to check in with us when you arrive before we can start making sales.

The shipping address is:
MAGFest Indies c/o Matthew Beale
4601-C Hollins Ferry Rd.
Halethorpe, MD 21227

Please let the Indies staff (indies@magfest.org) know if you choose this option so we know to look for your merch. Any fees incurred relating to the shipping will be deducted from your total sales.

Option B (not recommended): Ship your merch to National Harbor, pick it up when you arrive, and bring it to us. MAGFest does not cover any shipping costs or transport any packages except those sent to our warehouse. If you are unable to travel with your merch and unable to ship it in time to meet the warehouse deadline, the cheapest option is the UPS Store, which charges an acceptance fee ($15 or more) in addition to the shipping costs. Shipping directly to the Gaylord (via FedEx) is very expensive and not recommended. Please contact the UPS Store for information on their package acceptance policy: https://locations.theupsstore.com/md/national-harbor/145-fleet-st

And how do I pick it up after MAGFest is over?

We will be at Item Shoppe on Sunday between 10am-2pm for merch check-out. Please don't wait until the last minute for pick up, since check-out could take 30+ minutes. Everyone is typically trying to leave at the same time, so it can become chaotic if everyone's in a hurry and doesn't make the time. If you can schedule your pick-up time in advance, all the better. But fingers crossed, there won't be any merch left! Please let us know if you need to leave earlier than Sunday so we can have everything prepared in advance. ***You must check out your merch before you leave as we will not be able to return it to you otherwise.***

How much merch should I bring / what kind of items sell best?

It depends! Digital download codes are inexpensive for you to pack/ship, so go for it. Prints/posters are more difficult to transport the larger they are (we recommend supplying plastic sleeves!). Small and inexpensive items make great impulse purchases - especially stickers, pins, and patches. If you have items that are higher-tier (more expensive) or bulky, we recommend bringing a limited number. T-shirts (or hoodies, long-sleeves, tanks, etc) are a popular option, but please consider limiting the total inventory you bring. A small number of larger and smaller sizes are appreciated (particularly plus sizes), but most shirts sold are Medium, Large, or Extra-Large. **We request that you provide a maximum of 3 different shirt designs or 100 shirts total** unless you are certain of your merch's popularity from prior experience! Please remember that Item Shoppe has a limited amount of storage. If you're still not sure, please feel free to reach out to the Indies department heads. **Note: you cannot sell food or beverage.**

Our Studio has other projects as well, can we sell merch for them too?

Yes, at our discretion. All inventory you provide will be entered under a single contact person as a representative for the group, so you'll have to work out any profit splits amongst yourselves afterwards - we will provide a detailed breakdown of which items sold so you can calculate any splits.

Wow, this all sounds great, but WHAT'S THE CATCH?

The CATCH is that we need all of your info by the deadline: **December 13, 2026**. That's descriptions, pricing, inventory numbers, and item images. You are welcome to change item quantities closer to the event date, so you may estimate if needed, but **you cannot add any new items after the December 13 deadline**. We can't take any inventory at the event from anyone who hasn't already given us this info. No exceptions, so make sure you let us know!

I'm confused about how to opt in and add inventory

We have a new process this year to be more convenient and help everyone stay more organized! Please see the "Item Shoppe Opt In" tab if you need step by step instructions (with screenshots) for guidance.

I have more questions.

Cool! Reach out in the Indies Discord in #help-questions, or send us an email at indies@magfest.org!

We're very excited to offer this service to our MAGFest indie devs!

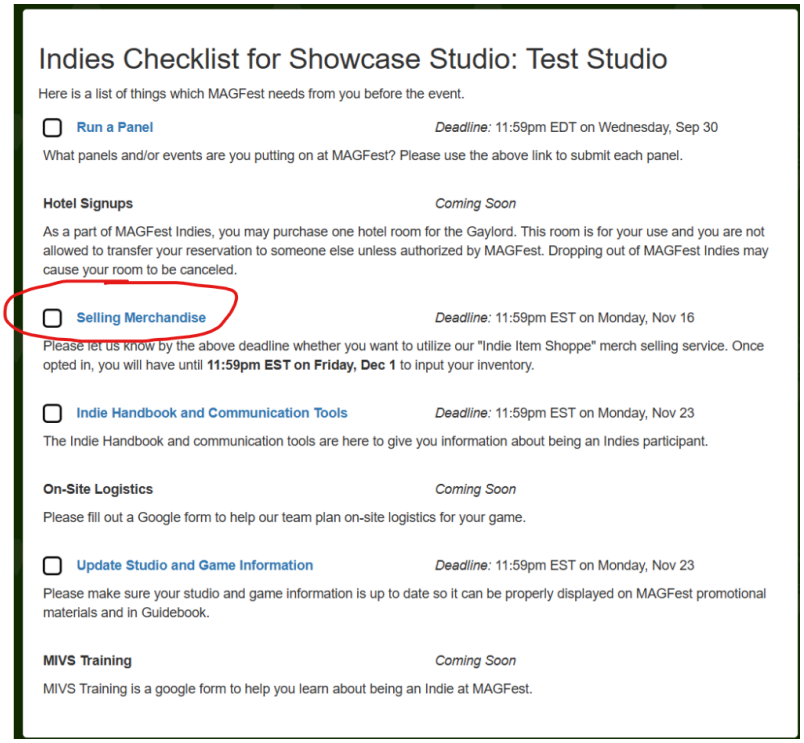
Indie Item Shoppe Opt-In

How do I opt in?

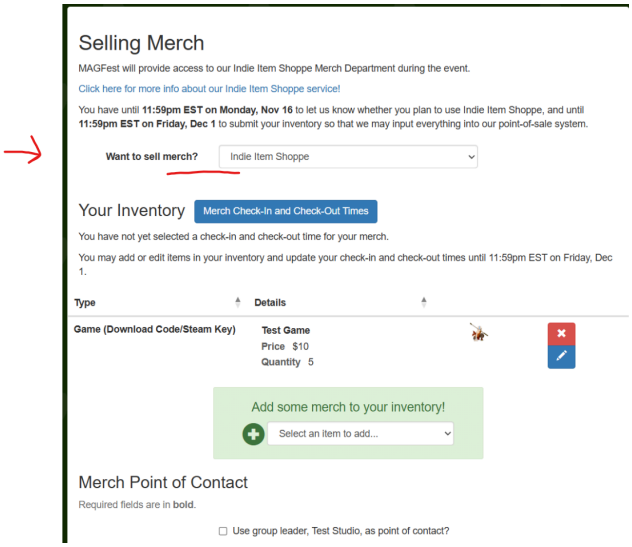
1. Log in at login.magfest.org. Use the email associated with your MAGFest ticket.
2. Go to your Indies Checklist:



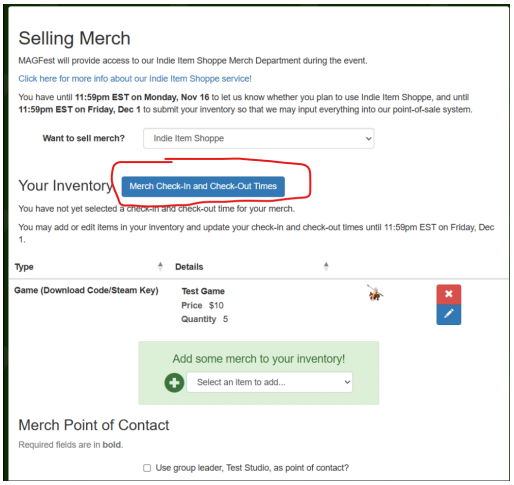
3. Click into the “Selling Merchandise” section

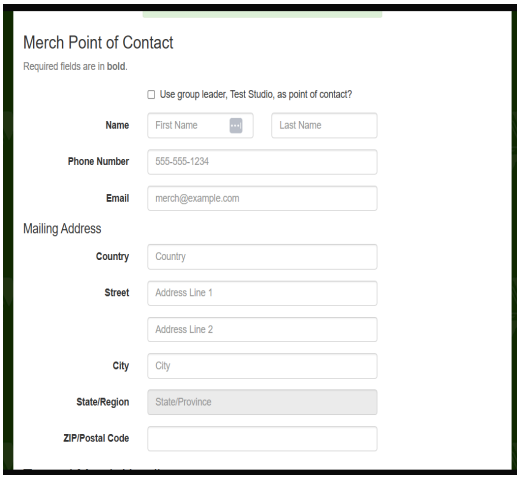


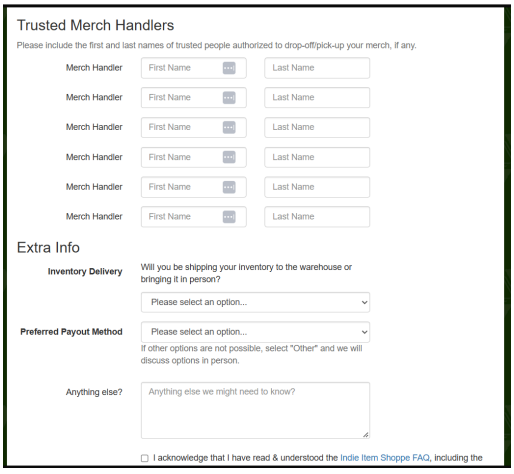
4. At the top of the page, opt in to sell your merch at the Indie Item Shoppe



5. Make sure to also fill out information for your Merch Check-in and Check-out Times, the Point of Contact for your merch, Trusted Merch Handlers who are allowed to handle your merch at the event, and extra information such as your Inventory Delivery method and how you prefer to be paid out after the event:

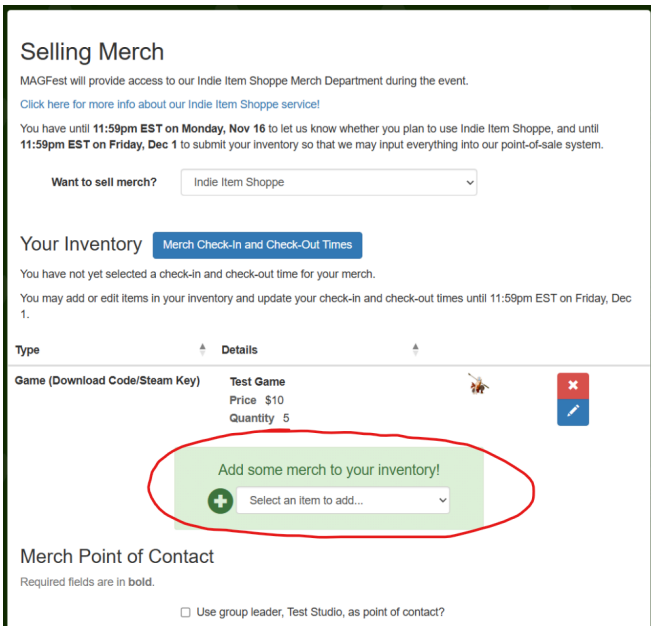




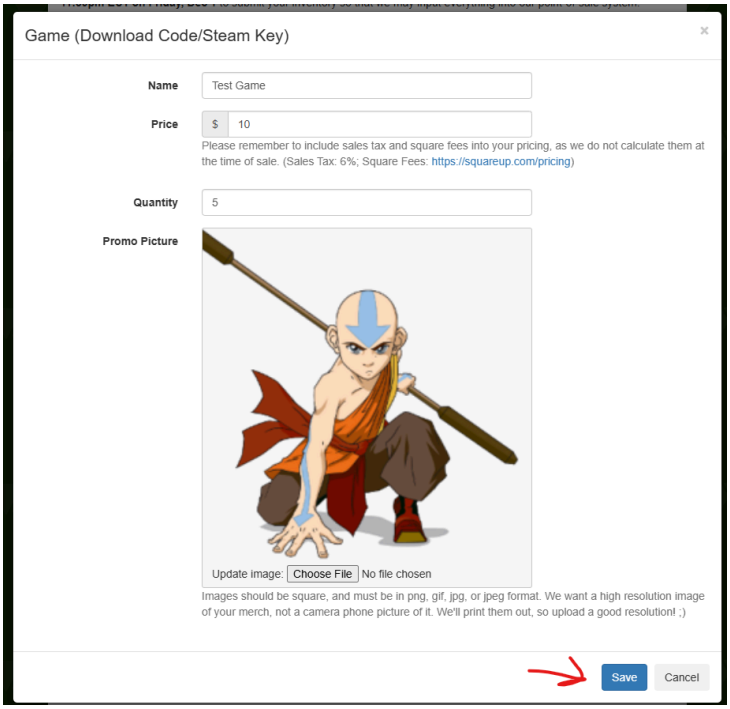


How do I add my merch as inventory?

1. Back in the Indies Checklist -> Selling Merchandise section (see Steps 1-3 above), near the top of the page is the “Your Inventory” section. Select an item type to add as inventory



2. A popup will appear, asking you to enter additional information about the item. Fill in the relevant information, upload an image of the item (if relevant) and click save



3. The item will now appear under “Your Inventory”. Repeat this to add each item you plan to sell in the Indie Item Shoppe

